

cinetonight.com

SEO / GEO / AEO Audit Report

FULL AUDIT

SEO

5

On Track

GEO

4

Needs Work

AEO

6

On Track

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Executive Summary

CineTonight is a technically sophisticated site undermined by a stale cache layer and a neglected page tier. The movie-page template, which Search Console data shows is the site's primary organic asset, is in good health: correct self-referencing canonicals, intent-targeted long-tail titles, clean branding and honest structured-data rules. The problem sits everywhere else. Several hub and custom pages are serving HTML generated months ago, before the MOVIEEX-to-CineTonight rebrand and before the migration off Vercel.

The single most damaging finding is /trending, which serves pre-rebrand HTML branded MOVIEEX carrying a cross-domain canonical to a dead cinetonight-lj9xhtkg1-cine-tonight.vercel.app preview host. A canonical pointing off-domain is an explicit instruction to Google to credit a different URL. Alongside this, the blog index is stale, missing the two newest posts while still listing a post that was retired and redirected, and both contact pages are non-functional stubs, one containing the literal body text "you can".

The biggest untapped opportunity is entity authority. The brand has effectively zero external footprint, no named authors, and a 250-word About page whose H1 does not even describe the page. For AI answer engines, which the robots.txt deliberately welcomes, that absence of verifiable authorship is the main thing standing between this site and citation.

Dimension	Score	Status	Key Takeaway
SEO	5/10	On Track	Strong movie template, but stale hubs, cross-domain canonical and stub pages drag the site down
GEO	4/10	Needs Work	AI crawlers welcomed, but no named authors, thin About page and zero brand entity presence
AEO	6/10	On Track	Genuinely good FAQ page and question-led blog structure; the strongest dimension
Combined	15/30		Fix the cache and page-tier defects first; they are suppressing otherwise sound work

Pages Audited

Twenty-seven URLs were fetched and inspected across every page template on the site.

URL	Type	Notes
/	Homepage	Clean title, canonical and OG tags. H1 "What should you watch tonight?"
/trending	Hub	CRITICAL: MOVIEEX branding, canonical points to vercel.app preview domain, no H1
/latest	Hub	MOVIEEX title tag; H1 is the generic "Your Entertainment Hub" boilerplate
/movies	Hub	Healthy. Correct title, canonical, H1 "Movies", 5-page cap
/tv-shows	Hub	Healthy. Correct title, canonical and H1
/web-series	Hub	No H1 detected; title carries the long duplicated brand suffix
/genres	Hub	No H1. Lists non-canonical genre values such as "Action & Adventure"
/discover	Hub	Healthy. Good description, correct canonical, H1 "Discover"
/free-movies	Landing	Strong legal explainer, 19 films, but long duplicated brand suffix
/blog	Index	STALE: missing the two newest posts, still lists a retired redirected post
/blog/what-to-watch-on-netflix	Article	2,200 words, 50 picks, correct canonical, published 25 Aug
/blog/best-anime-for-beginners	Article	1,400 words, real verified movie links, published 24 Aug
/blog/cant-decide-what-to-watch-tonight	Article	Strong. Links to a retired slug that now redirects
/blog/cocktail-2-ott-release-date	Article	Rebuilt successfully: 5 body H2s, FAQ, ~950 words
/movie/lanterns	Movie	Healthy. Correct canonical, intended title, clean branding
/movie/toy-story-5	Movie	Healthy. Correct canonical and title pattern
/movie/spider-man-brand-new-day	Movie	Healthy. Correct canonical and title pattern
/channel/netflix	Channel	Thin editorial text; long duplicated

URL	Type	Notes
		brand suffix in title
/faq	FAQ	Best AEO asset on the site: 12 concise question headings
/about-us	Custom	BROKEN: H1 is generic boilerplate, ~250 words, no named people
/contact	Custom	BROKEN: no contact details, generic boilerplate H1
/contact-us	Custom	BROKEN: body text is literally "you can". Duplicates /contact
/privacy-policy	Legal	BROKEN: no H1, roughly 85 words of real content
/terms-of-service	Legal	Healthy. ~650 words of genuine terms, dated 14 Aug 2026
/follow	Custom	Correct H1; title carries the long duplicated brand suffix
/robots.txt	Directive	Healthy and matches source. Googlebot fully allowed
/sitemap.xml	Directive	463 URLs. Only 180 movie pages against ~24,000 indexed

SEO Analysis — 5/10

Technical On-Page

Signal	Finding	Status
Title tags	Movie, blog and FAQ titles are correct and intent-led. Hub and custom pages append the full tagline, producing titles near 95 characters	Needs Attention
Cross-domain canonical	/trending canonicals to cinetonight-lj9xhtkg1-cinetonight.vercel.app, instructing Google to credit a dead preview host	Broken
Stale rendered HTML	/trending and /latest serve pre-rebrand MOVIEEX titles; several hubs carry an obsolete brand suffix	Broken

Signal	Finding	Status
H1 presence	Missing entirely on /genres, /web-series, /privacy-policy, /trending. Generic boilerplate H1 on /about-us, /contact, /latest	Broken
Meta descriptions	Present and well written on homepage, hubs, blog and movie pages. Hard-sliced at 158 characters on some movie pages	Needs Attention
Duplicate pages	/contact and /contact-us both exist and are both indexed; neither carries real contact information	Broken
Canonical (money pages)	Movie pages carry correct self-referencing canonicals and enforce one URL per title with a 308	Good
Robots directives	robots.txt matches source exactly. Googlebot unrestricted. 11 scraper bots blocked deliberately	Good
Viewport / mobile	width=device-width, initial-scale=1 present	Good
Open Graph / Twitter	Complete on homepage: og:title, description, image 1200x630, alt, twitter:summary_large_image	Good
HTTPS	Site served over HTTPS with HSTS preload configured	Good
Genre URL hygiene	/genres links to non-canonical values such as "Action & Adventure" which middleware then 308s away	Needs Attention

Content Quality

Signal	Finding	Status
Sitemap coverage	Only 180 movie URLs submitted against roughly 24,000 indexed pages. Top earners such as Hallam Foe and Nando Between Two Worlds are absent entirely	Needs Attention
Blog index freshness	Index omits the two newest posts and still lists a retired, redirected post. Ordering is not strictly reverse-chronological	Broken
Thin legal pages	/privacy-policy contains roughly	Broken

Signal	Finding	Status
	85 words. A privacy policy of that length is not a usable legal document	
Thin OTT posts	Three release-date posts remain near-identical templates. Cocktail 2 was rebuilt to ~950 words; Michael and Jana Nayagan remain thin	Needs Attention
Expired content	/blog/what-to-watch-this-weekend-august-21-23-2026 carries a dated slug whose window has passed	Needs Attention
Internal links from articles	The anime post links to real verified movie URLs. Older posts link only to hubs, not to individual movie pages	Needs Attention
Link to redirected slug	cant-decide-what-to-watch-tonight links in-body to a slug that now 308s, adding an avoidable hop	Needs Attention
Flagship content depth	Netflix post at 2,200 words with 50 picks, anime post at 1,400 words, date-night at ~2,100 words	Good
Free classics landing	Roughly 280 words explaining Indian copyright duration and public-domain status. Genuinely useful and differentiated	Good

Structured Data

Signal	Finding	Status
Movie / TVSeries schema	Source confirms correct JSON-LD: TVSeries for series, datePublished only when genuinely released, no fabricated ratingCount	Good
FAQPage schema	Source confirms FAQ schema is generated from each article's own FAQ headings. Could not be verified on the live page (see limitations)	Good
BreadcrumbList	Generated for both movie and blog templates in source	Good
Organization schema	Could not be confirmed live. No named publisher entity surfaced in the crawl beyond the blog	Needs Attention

Signal	Finding	Status
	publisher block	
Live schema verification	The fetch tool strips script tags, so no JSON-LD could be read from the live HTML. Run Google Rich Results Test to confirm	Needs Attention

GEO Analysis — 4/10

GEO is about being the kind of source an AI answer engine will quote and name. This site invites AI crawlers in, then gives them almost nothing to attribute the content to.

E-E-A-T Assessment

Signal	Finding	Status
Named authors	Every article is bylined "Editorial Desk". No named human author, no bio, no credentials anywhere on the site	Missing
About page	Roughly 250 words. H1 reads "Your Entertainment Hub. Watch the latest movies and web series in HD quality", which does not describe the page	Broken
Contact information	No email, form, phone or address on either /contact or /contact-us. Both are stubs	Broken
Editorial policy	No published policy despite the project maintaining a strict internal certainty convention of Confirmed, Reported or inference	Missing
Trust signals	No testimonials, awards, press mentions or certifications present	Missing
Data attribution	TMDB attribution present and correctly worded on About and in the footer	Good
Legal transparency	Terms of Service is substantive at ~650 words and dated. Privacy Policy is not	Needs Attention
Social profiles	Facebook, X, Instagram, YouTube and TikTok all linked from the footer, supporting the entity graph	Good

Content for AI Synthesis

Signal	Finding	Status
Factual density	Release-date posts label claims as Confirmed or Reported, which is exactly the pattern answer engines reward	Good
Clear claims up front	Cocktail 2 opens with the direct answer before elaborating. Michael and Jana Nayagan do the same	Good
External source citation	Content references trade reporting in prose but does not link to primary sources	Needs Attention
Entity clarity	Brand named consistently on healthy pages, but MOVIE X still appears in two live title tags, splitting the entity signal	Broken
External brand presence	A brand search returns competitors such as CineVibe, CineNightly, Cineo and The Movies Finder. CineTonight does not appear	Missing
Originality	The free classics explainer and the mood-based framing are genuinely differentiated. Release-date posts are commodity content	Needs Attention
Comprehensiveness	Netflix and anime posts fully resolve their questions. The three thin OTT posts do not	Needs Attention

Technical GEO

Signal	Finding	Status
AI crawler policy	GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot, OAI-SearchBot, CCBot, Meta-ExternalAgent and Amazonbot explicitly allowed. A deliberate and correct GEO posture	Good
Crawl efficiency	Aggressive commercial crawlers blocked; unbounded person and search spaces excluded from AI crawlers	Good
Server-rendered HTML	Pages render server-side, so AI crawlers receive complete HTML	Good

Signal	Finding	Status
	without executing JavaScript	
Cache integrity	Stale pre-rebrand HTML being served to crawlers actively corrupts the entity signal	Broken
sameAs / entity links	Five social profiles linked, but no confirmed Organization schema binding them to the brand entity	Needs Attention

AEO Analysis — 6/10

This is the site's strongest dimension. The question-led writing convention already in use is exactly what answer engines extract from.

Featured Snippet Eligibility

Signal	Finding	Status
Direct answer paragraphs	Cocktail 2 answers the core question in its first sentence. The FAQ page answers all 12 questions in 2 to 4 sentences	Good
Definition patterns	"What is CineTonight?" answered plainly on /faq in a clean definitional sentence	Good
List content	The Netflix post contains 50 discrete H3 entries, well structured for list snippets	Good
Table content	The anime post opens with a comparison table mapping viewer taste to a recommended title	Good
Question-phrased headings	Used consistently: "Which anime should you watch first?", "What should you watch on Netflix tonight?", "Is it worth your evening?"	Good
Snippet-blocking staleness	A stale blog index means new answer content is not linked from its own hub, slowing discovery	Needs Attention

Structured Answer Formats

Signal	Finding	Status
FAQ schema on articles	Generated automatically from each article's FAQ headings. Six of the crawled posts carry a real FAQ section	Good
FAQ schema on /faq	The strongest FAQ content on the site sits on a page whose schema could not be confirmed. Likely the single easiest AEO win available	Needs Attention
HowTo schema	No HowTo markup. The five-minute decision method in cant-decide-what-to-watch-tonight is a natural candidate	Missing
Speakable schema	Not implemented anywhere on the site	Missing
Breadcrumbs	Present on movie and blog templates	Good

Voice Search Readiness

Signal	Finding	Status
Conversational phrasing	Content reads naturally and addresses the reader directly, matching spoken query patterns	Good
Long-tail question coverage	Movie titles target "cast, trailer and where to watch", which mirrors real spoken queries	Good
Who / what / when coverage	Release-date posts answer when and where precisely. Who is weaker with no named authors	Needs Attention
Local signals	Region-aware availability is implemented, but no NAP data or LocalBusiness schema. Appropriate for a non-local publisher	Good

Priority Recommendations

Ordered by impact against effort. The three Critical items are all low-effort and are actively suppressing work that is otherwise sound.

Priority	Issue	Dimension	Effort	Impact
Critical	Remove the cross-domain canonical on /trending pointing at the vercel.app preview host, and purge the stale cache objects serving pre-rebrand MOVIEEX HTML	SEO / GEO	Low	Very High
Critical	Repair the blog index so it lists the two newest posts and drops the retired redirected post	SEO	Low	High
Critical	Replace the /privacy-policy stub with a real policy, and fix or consolidate /contact and /contact-us, one of which has the body text "you can"	SEO / GEO	Low	High
High	Fix the generic boilerplate H1 leaking onto /about-us, /contact and /latest, and add missing H1s to /genres, /web-series, /privacy-policy and /trending	SEO	Low	High
High	Normalise the title suffix so hub and custom pages use the short brand rather than the full tagline, which pushes titles near 95 characters	SEO	Low	Medium
High	Rewrite the About page with named people, real credentials and a published editorial policy, and give articles a real byline	GEO	Medium	Very High

Priority	Issue	Dimension	Effort	Impact
Medium	Expand sitemap movie coverage. 180 URLs against ~24,000 indexed pages leaves the top earners undiscoverable except by internal link	SEO	Medium	High
Medium	Merge or thicken the remaining thin OTT posts, and resolve the expired dated weekend post	SEO	Medium	Medium
Medium	Add contextual in-body links from articles to individual movie pages, following the pattern the anime post already sets	SEO	Medium	High
Quick Win	Confirm FAQPage schema on /faq. Twelve well-written concise answers already sit there	AEO	Low	Medium
Quick Win	Point /genres at canonical genre values so it stops linking through a 308	SEO	Low	Low
Quick Win	Fix the in-body link in cant-decide-what-to-watch-tonight that points at a redirected slug	SEO	Low	Low

What's Working Well

These are genuine strengths confirmed during the crawl, not consolation prizes.

Movie page template	Correct self-referencing canonicals, one-URL-per-title enforced with a real 308, and intent-led titles in the form "Title (Year) — Cast, Trailer & Where to Watch". Verified clean on Lanterns, Toy Story 5 and Spider-Man: Brand New Day
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Honest structured data	Source rules refuse to fabricate. aggregateRating is emitted only with genuine votes, datePublished only for genuinely released titles, and series are correctly typed TVSeries
Deliberate crawler policy	Eleven commercial scrapers blocked while every major AI and search crawler is welcomed. This is a considered GEO position, not an accident
The FAQ page	Twelve genuine questions with concise 2 to 4 sentence answers. The best answer-engine asset on the site as it stands
Free classics explainer	Roughly 280 words explaining Indian copyright duration and public-domain status. Differentiated, useful and defensible content that competitors do not have
Blog rebuild executed correctly	Cocktail 2 went from 223 words with zero body headings to roughly 950 words with five H2s and a six-question FAQ, and the cache purge was performed properly
Person page containment	Person pages correctly carry noindex with follow, are absent from the sitemap, and remain crawlable so Google can read the directive and drop them
Terms of Service	A substantive, dated, genuinely useful legal document at roughly 650 words
Recent content quality	The Netflix post at 2,200 words and the anime post at 1,400 words are both strong, and the anime post links out to real verified movie URLs

Limitations of This Audit

What could not be assessed with the tools available, and which tool to use instead.

- Live JSON-LD could not be read. The fetch tool converts pages to markdown and strips script tags, so all schema findings are based on source code rather than rendered output. Confirm with Google Rich Results Test at search.google.com/test/rich-results.
- HTTP response headers were not observable, so the exact cache layer responsible for the stale pages (Cloudflare edge versus the R2 incremental cache) could not be isolated. Run `curl -I` against /trending and compare age and cf-cache-status headers.
- Core Web Vitals, real page speed and mobile rendering were not measured. Run PageSpeed Insights at pagespeed.web.dev.
- Backlink profile and domain authority were not assessed. The Ahrefs project already connected to this domain is the right tool.
- Ranking positions were not verified. Search Console remains the authoritative source, and manual SERP checks are known to disagree with it on this site.

Glossary

SEO

Search Engine Optimization. Making pages discoverable and rankable in conventional search results through technical health, content quality and structured data.

GEO

Generative Engine Optimization. Making a site the kind of source that AI answer engines such as ChatGPT Search, Perplexity, Gemini and Google AI Overviews will synthesise from and cite. It rewards verifiable authorship, factual precision and a clear brand entity.

AEO

Answer Engine Optimization. Structuring content so a direct answer can be lifted cleanly into a featured snippet, a People Also Ask box or a voice response. Concise answers under question-phrased headings, backed by FAQ or HowTo schema.

Canonical

A tag declaring the authoritative URL for a page. Pointing it at another domain tells search engines to credit that domain instead of yours.

E-E-A-T

Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness and Trustworthiness. Google's framework for assessing whether a source deserves to be trusted, and a major input to AI citation decisions.